Remix

Are you curious about the development environment of the Solidity smart contract, editing it, compiling it, setting up and configuring a blockchain, deploying the compiled code on this chain, and testing it? Remix provides a cool web/cloud-based integrated development environment with no installation required. Not only that, but it also scaffolds a JavaScript-based simulated test chain environment where you can deploy your smart contract code and test it! This all-in-one environment also allows you to onboard your tested application to external blockchains other than the test chain supported by Remix.

2.4.1 The Remix IDE

The Remix IDE (figure 2.6) is directly accessible at https://remix.ethereum.org. You can open it and follow along as we discuss its features. This version is the latest version as of February 2020. The Remix IDE layout changes yearly to optimize user experience, but the concepts are the same. Be aware that the layout may change again next year and that the color schemes for the buttons also change frequently.

Figure 2.6 shows the seven features of the Remix IDE that you'll use in working with the development of a smart contract. Open the Remix IDE, identify the items indicated, and follow along with the explanation provided. (Note that I've chosen the light theme from the settings icon at the bottom corner, so that Remix appears better for print material.)